

## **LEAVE AND TIME-OFF POLICY**

### **1. Annual Leave**

All permanent employees are entitled to paid annual leave as follows:

- 0 to 2 years of service: 14 days per calendar year
- 3 to 4 years of service: 18 days per calendar year
- 5 or more years of service: 21 days per calendar year

Annual leave must be applied for at least 5 working days in advance and is subject to manager approval. Unused annual leave of up to 5 days may be carried forward to the following calendar year. Any remaining balance after carry-forward is forfeited unless special approval is granted by HR.

### **2. Sick Leave**

All permanent employees are entitled to 10 days of paid sick leave per year. Sick leave is non-cumulative and resets on January 1 each year.

For absences of 3 or more consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner must be submitted to HR within 2 working days of returning to work. Failure to produce a certificate may result in the absence being treated as unpaid leave.

### **3. Maternity and Paternity Leave**

Primary caregiver (Maternity Leave):

- 16 weeks of fully paid maternity leave
- Applicable to employees with at least 6 months of service
- Leave may commence up to 4 weeks before the expected due date

Secondary caregiver (Paternity Leave):

- 4 weeks of fully paid paternity leave
- Must be taken within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption

Employees must notify HR at least 8 weeks before the intended start date and provide supporting documentation (e.g., birth certificate or medical letter confirming expected due date).

### **4. Public Holidays**

Employees are entitled to all gazetted public holidays in the country of their primary work location. If an employee is required to work on a public holiday, they will receive an alternative day off or a 1.5x pay supplement, at the discretion of their department head.

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## 5. Unpaid Leave

Employees may apply for unpaid leave of up to 30 calendar days per year for personal reasons. Approval is at the sole discretion of the department head and HR. Unpaid leave does not affect the employee's annual leave entitlement but will result in a pro-rated deduction of salary for the period taken.

## 6. Emergency and Compassionate Leave

Up to 3 days of paid emergency or compassionate leave may be granted for:

- Death of an immediate family member (spouse, parent, child, sibling)
- Serious illness of a family member requiring hospitalisation
- Natural disaster directly affecting the employee's household

Supporting documents must be submitted to HR within 5 working days.